

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, cloudy, breezy, humid, high 82. **Tonight**, cloudy, humid, thunderstorms, low 73. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, humid, showers and thunderstorms, high 83. Weather map, Page 20.

VOL. CLXXV ... No. 60,964

© 2026 The New York Times Company

SUNDAY, AUGUST 2, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



Migrants waited on a beach for assistance on Saturday after a sudden exodus from Morocco. At least 67 people died in the chaos.

FINBARR O'REILLY FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

G.O.P. ABOUT-FACE ON MILITARY I.V.F.

Bid to Expand Access to
Treatments Is Killed

By **ANNIE KARNI**
WASHINGTON — Republicans in Congress have quietly blocked a proposal to expand military health coverage of in vitro fertilization treatment for service members and their families, heeding the calls of anti-abortion groups to limit access to a fertility option that President Trump vowed to make more widely available.

The move is a shift from previous years, when there was enough bipartisan support for the idea of broadening the availability of I.V.F. for members of the military that it was included in the annual defense bill that passed both the House and Senate. Speaker Mike Johnson later stripped it out in final negotiations before the legislation became law, but the provision's initial inclusion indicated that the vast majority of Republicans had been willing to accept it.

This year, Republican senators banded together to bar the measure from being added to the defense bill in the first place. It illustrated how, while many G.O.P. members of Congress have said they are in favor of I.V.F. access, they have managed behind the scenes to thwart legislative efforts to ensure it.

During a closed-door meeting of the Senate Armed Services Committee earlier this summer to draft the defense bill, all 14 Republican senators voted against adding the I.V.F. coverage provision, offered by Senator Tammy Duckworth, Democrat of Illinois.

The military currently covers the treatments only for active-duty service members whose infertility was caused by an injury or illness sustained in the line of duty. Ms. Duckworth's proposal would make it available to other service members and their families.

Its outright defeat was a stark turnabout from last year, when the Republican-led panel allowed Ms. Duckworth's proposal to be added by a voice vote, in which senators do not go on the record with a position but unanimous support is assumed. The defense bill then passed the Senate and the House with the language included, though Mr. Johnson later intervened to remove it, the second year in a row he had done so.

Continued on Page 18

The Brief, Puzzling Surge Into a Spanish Enclave

By **JASON HOROWITZ**
CEUTA, Spain — Like so many others in Morocco, Mohammed Ahmidho saw on his social media feeds early Thursday that the heavily guarded border his country shared with the Spanish territory of Ceuta was open.

Soon enough, he joined a crowd in the tens of thousands, many of whom were astonished to see Moroccan police urge them, as he recalled, to “come to Spain.” Some climbed over the fence, as he did, or dove through holes in the chain-

**50,000 From Morocco
Overwhelm Ceuta, a
City of 84,000**

link, or swam across the maritime border. Some wore wet suits, sometimes kicking with flippers, or floated to the Spanish coast in orange life preservers, pink inflatable doughnuts around their waists. At least 67 people died in the mayhem.

“A lot of people came,” said Mr. Ahmidho, 37. “A lot.”

He was among roughly 50,000 people who crossed the border into a Spanish city of only 84,000 residents on Thursday and early Friday, according to the Spanish interior ministry. That was a more intense surge than in any equivalent period during the peak of the European migration crisis in 2015.

By Friday morning, the city looked like the emergency that Europe has been trying to avoid since that era of mass migration 11

Continued on Page 10



NIC CORY FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

So much wine has gone unsold in California that vineyards are ripping out and burning the vines.

Vintners Are Tearing Out Their Hair, and Vines

By **SOUMYA KARLAMANGLA**

SOLEDAD, Calif. — In California, a place famous around the world for its viticulture, winemakers produced less wine last year than at any point in the last quarter century. It's often cheaper to let grapes rot on the vine than to harvest them because so many unsold bottles clog the shelves of storerooms and wine shops.

So on a sunny morning in Soledad, Calif., in a valley made famous by the author John Steinbeck, Jason Smith acquiesced to simple economics.

A worker unceremoniously drove a tractor and ripped out Mr. Smith's pinot noir grapes from the ground. Another set fire to the

**California Hit as Wine
Sales Plummet**

wooden posts that for years had propped up the vines. And Mr. Smith leaned against his white Suburban, under the shade of a coastal oak, watching one of his pinot vineyards go up in smoke.

He had decided to sell all of his land and shut down his family business, which had survived for 51 years. “There's literally no way for me to make money,” Mr. Smith, 57, said.

Nationwide, wine sales are at their lowest level in more than two decades, as people drink less amid

growing public health warnings that alcohol is unhealthy. Sales have also suffered as many younger drinkers have found traditional wines stodgy and difficult to understand, and preferred canned cocktails, seltzers and nonalcoholic beers and spirits.

In California, which produces about 80 percent of the nation's wines, pinot noir perhaps best illustrates the industry's recent boom-and-bust history.

The light-bodied wine originally from France's Burgundy region was once less popular among average wine drinkers here than reds such as cabernet sauvignon and merlot. Then came the 2004 movie “Sideways,” which starred

Continued on Page 13

How a Leading Law Firm Stopped Fighting Trump

**At Paul Weiss, Pursuit of Corporate Work
Clashed With Proud Activist History**

By **MICHAEL S. SCHMIDT** and **JESSICA SILVER-GREENBERG**

On his desk at the law firm Paul Weiss, Brad Karp keeps a framed picture of a young girl and her father embracing after they had been separated at the border by the immigration policies of the first Trump administration. It is a reminder of one of the firm's proudest moments — when Mr. Karp, as chairman, led its lawyers to fight the administration in court and undertake the painstaking work to reunite families.

“It was a call to arms,” Mr. Karp said later.

But two months into the second Trump administration, when the president came for Paul Weiss with an executive order imposing crippling sanctions, Mr. Karp did not just lay down arms. He rushed to the White House to surrender.

The legal and political worlds were shocked. Paul Weiss was a titan in the legal business, known for its stable of elite litigators and for its history of standing up to the government and championing progressive causes going back to the civil rights movement. But sitting in the Oval Office in March 2025, Mr. Karp bent without a fight to an executive order that was widely seen as illegal.

Four law firms that fought similar executive orders won quick injunctions from incensed judges, making Paul Weiss's capitulation particularly consequential for President Trump's retribution campaign against an array of perceived enemies. Eight other firms followed Paul Weiss in making deals with the White House, agreeing to perform a total of nearly \$1 billion in free legal work for causes Mr. Trump supported.

“They're just saying, ‘Where do I sign?’” Mr. Trump bragged. “No one can believe it.”

But behind the public disbelief was a deeper story of an institution that had slowly come loose from its roots. That story, pieced together in a New York Times investigation, reveals that Paul Weiss's bow to the White House was the culmination of a reordering of power and finances behind the scenes at the firm for years.

The shift had begun when Mr. Karp decided years earlier to develop a more robust corporate

practice alongside Paul Weiss's litigation work. The wealthy firm became even wealthier, partly by riding the growth of private equity and the lucrative legal work generated by the rapid buying and selling of companies.

But the Times reporting, based on extensive interviews with current and former lawyers at the firm, access to internal documents and communications, and detailed accounts of firm meetings, shows there was a cost. The pursuit of Wall Street business in service of higher profits per partner — a key metric for law firms — was at odds with its social justice principles. When Mr. Trump took aim at Paul Weiss, in part because of its activist history, the firm's long-simmering identity crisis became an existential crisis.

At the center of the conflict were two dominant and very different figures — Mr. Karp and Scott Barshay, whom Mr. Karp had hired to supercharge the corporate practice.

Mr. Karp, described by colleagues as the consummate people pleaser, sometimes to a fault, tried to keep happy both the socially conscious litigators and the increasing crop of corporate lawyers. Mr. Barshay, the colleagues say, is a driven dealmaker, aggressive to the point of being abra-

Continued on Page 14



JOSHUA BRIGHT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Brad Karp, former chairman of Paul Weiss. The firm took on the first Trump administration.

Space Junk Comes in Pieces, Posing a Threat to Earthlings

By **SELAM GEBREKIDAN**

HONG KONG — One December afternoon, the sky tore open and a fiery hunk of metal, wider than a school bus, came hurtling down.

It was louder than a thunderclap when it plunged into a patch of farmland, startling everyone in the village of Mukuku, about three hours south of Nairobi, Kenya.

“People were thinking this is the end of the world,” said John Mukunuu, who lives nearby.

When the villagers arrived, they found a giant ring, taller than a man and heavier than a horse, lodged into the earth. They watched it cool from a glowing ember to a dull gray. They guarded it, taking the occasional selfie, until officials from the capital swarmed the village.

The ring had once connected parts of a rocket. It was supposed to have burned up on its return to Earth.

“This is an isolated event,” the Kenya Space Agency said in early 2025.

Not exactly.

More space debris is raining down on Earth than ever before — one effect of the frenetic race among governments and compa-

**Flaming Debris Hitting
Homes and Farms**

nies like SpaceX to reign over the skies.

Last year, the U.S. Space Force issued alerts for nearly 820 objects entering the Earth's atmosphere. The government issued alerts for 110 objects a decade ago.

“The re-entries happen each and every day,” said Mariusz Slonina, who heads space situational awareness operations for the Polish Space Agency. Huge objects weighing a metric ton or more arrive about once a week, he said.

Much of the debris incinerates in the atmosphere or splashes into the Pacific, but when it does not, it plummets to the ground, uncontrolled and unpredictable.

The more objects humans launch into orbit, the more debris they will have to dodge on Earth. More than 300 rockets launched last year, nearly four times as many as a decade ago. That means many more bits and spent parts are expected to drop back.

Dying satellites are another

Continued on Page 8

INTERNATIONAL 4-11

Kyiv’s Inroads Into MAGA

A visit to Ukraine by Laura Loomer, the right-wing activist, may help to undo skepticism of its war effort among President Trump's supporters. PAGE 9

Israel Bombards Gaza

At least two people were killed in strikes that imperiled a U.S.-backed deal with Hamas to advance a truce. PAGE 7

SPORTS 22-24

Brunson’s Route to Greatness

How did Jalen Brunson become a champion and a New York legend? These moments tell the story. PAGE 22

SUNDAY STYLES

Goodbye to the Bar Scene?

Alcohol is unhealthy, but what gets lost when we give up drinking? PAGE 10

ARTS & LEISURE

Sam Smith, Here to Be Happy

The singer, known for songs about heartbreak, has a joyful album. PAGE 6



SUNDAY BUSINESS

When A.I. Invaded Fan Fiction

An anonymous X account posted a detailed breakdown of chatbot text in 38 popular stories that were inspired by “Heated Rivalry.” Anger ensued. PAGE 1

Beyond Baby Monitoring

Nanit, Owlet and other start-ups provide a level of data that some find delightful and others see as creepy. PAGE 6

REAL ESTATE

At Home on the Waves

A man who has lived on a luxury catamaran for 15 years is at risk of being set adrift. PAGE 8

METROPOLITAN

The Spread of an Illness

New York has become an epicenter of Legionnaires' disease, with a significant outbreak over the past month. PAGE 1

Where It’s Hot and Humorous

A comedian and his friends have turned a subway platform's vacant newsstand into an interactive art project. PAGE 1



OBITUARIES 25-27

Witnessed King Assassination

Clara Ester, 78, was a college student when she saw the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. get shot in Memphis. PAGE 25

A Mime Who Spoke Out

Ronald G. Davis guided the San Francisco Mime Troupe's satire of all things Establishment. He was 92. PAGE 25

SUNDAY OPINION

Catherine Shannon

PAGE 6

